

then turn it into greyscale on a computer. Portraits and landscapes are two common and effective subjects for greyscale images. Increase the contrast to bring out the detailing in greyscale images. Compare if the image looks better in greyscale than it does in colour.

Sepia:

The sepia tone in old photographs is the result of a chemical used in the printing process of black-and-white photographs that allowed the photos to last longer. Modern digital cameras and dSLRs have this as an added feature. Again, this is another abused feature. While taking a photo in the Sepia mode might seem fancy, it is considered terribly amateurish and is hardly ever used effectively.

1.3 Shooting modes

Shooting modes are used in digital cameras to compensate for the aperture, shutter speed and exposure settings available in analogue SLR cameras. Some shooting modes like red-eye reduction and the text mode use algorithms to work on the RAW data and create a better image. There are versatile shooting modes available across the range of consumer digital cameras, and working with them can often be confusing. Most users simply use “auto”, or have a highly functional approach to shooting modes — using the portrait mode for shooting portraits or the macro mode for shooting close-ups. Understanding how these modes work will allow users to experiment and better adapt the modes for their purposes.

Action/Sport:

In most cameras, the icon for the Action or the Sport/s mode is a sprinter. In this mode, the camera uses a very high shutter speed, and typically, a small aperture. This means that the sensor in the camera is exposed to light for a very short amount of time, in some cameras, for the shortest amount of time allowed by the mechanism. This reduces the blur of fast moving objects. It is essential that this mode is used only in ample light conditions, as the sensor receives very little light. Some cameras compensate for this by artificially boosting the